

Your desktops have names *now.*

Jumpee is a small macOS menu bar app that names your Mission Control desktops, jumps you between them from the keyboard, and prints the name of the one you are on straight onto the wallpaper.

A product tour · what it does, how to install it, how to configure it
Version 1.8.0 · September 2026



INTRODUCTION

Mission Control gives you numbers, *not names*.

THE SYMPTOM

Desktop 3 is a guess

macOS labels spaces Desktop 1, 2, 3 and stops there. Nothing on screen tells you that Desktop 3 holds the mail and Desktop 5 is the build machine.

THE GAP

Renaming is not a feature

There is no supported way to name a space – no public API, no System Settings switch, no checkbox anywhere in Mission Control.

THE FRICTION

Windows land in the wrong place

Sending a window to another desktop means dragging it to the screen edge and waiting, or enabling a Mission Control shortcut most people never touch.

Jumpee closes all three. It reads the space you are on, keeps a name against it, and gives you a keyboard route to every other one.

INTRODUCTION

A menu bar app that *knows where you are*.

01

Name

Give every desktop a name. Names are stored against the space itself, so they survive reordering in Mission Control.

02

Jump

A global hotkey opens the list from anywhere, and number keys jump. `⌘J`, then `3`.

03

Show

The current desktop's name sits in the menu bar, and a faint watermark prints it on the wallpaper itself.

04

Manage

Send the focused window to another desktop, pin a window on top, and keep an eye on the keyboard language.

One small native app. No dock icon, no main window, no account, no network. It lives in the menu bar and gets out of the way.



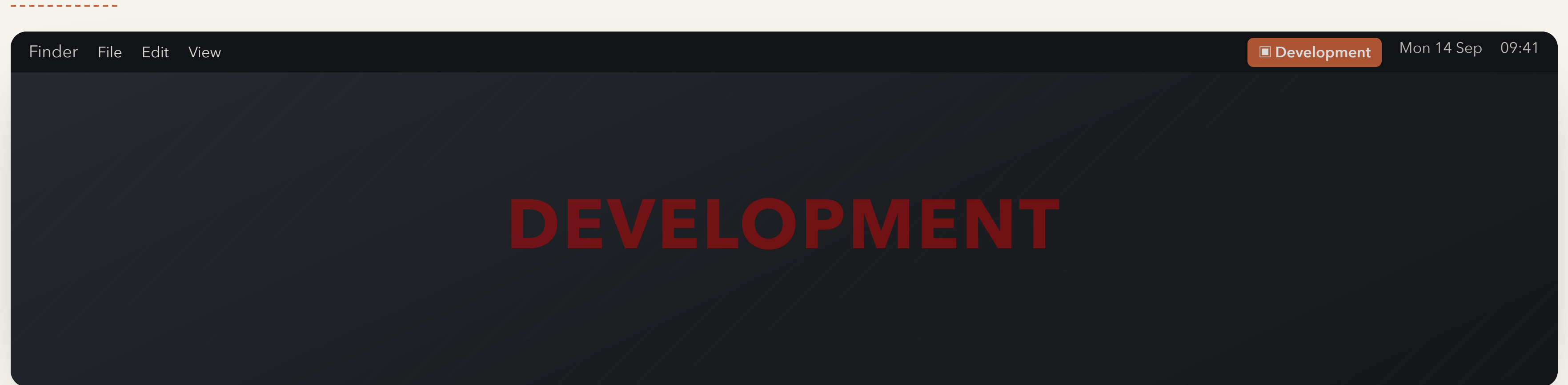
01

What it does

Naming and jumping, the wallpaper watermark, and the three window-and-keyboard features that grew out of them.

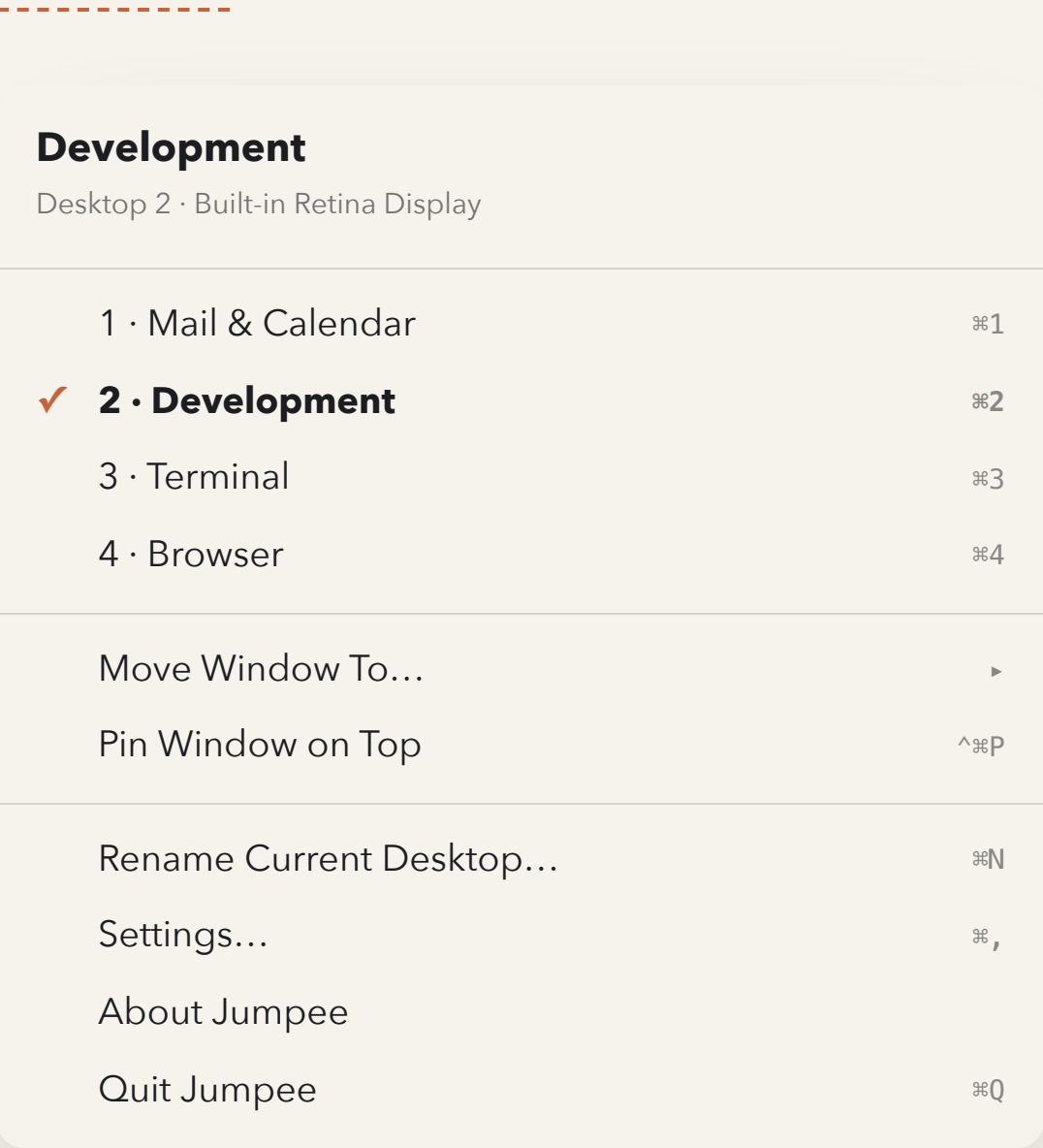


The name of the desktop you are on, always in sight.



The status item carries the system display symbol and the current space's name. **Settings › General** decides whether the desktop number comes along – **4: Browser** or just **Browser**. Unnamed desktops still read **Desktop 2**. The mock above shows the watermark at 35% opacity for legibility; the shipped default is 15%.

Every desktop on this display, one click away.



- 1 Current desktop as a heading**
The same context the menu bar shows, repeated where you are already looking – name, desktop number and display.
- 2 The desktops themselves**
Only the active display's spaces, numbered as that display numbers them. A tick marks where you are; clicking any other one jumps straight there.
- 3 The window actions**
Move the focused window to another desktop, or pin it above everything else. Both are described later in this section.
- 4 Desktop and app commands**
Rename, Settings, About and Quit. Persistent preferences deliberately live in Settings, not in this menu.

Everything is reachable *without the mouse.*

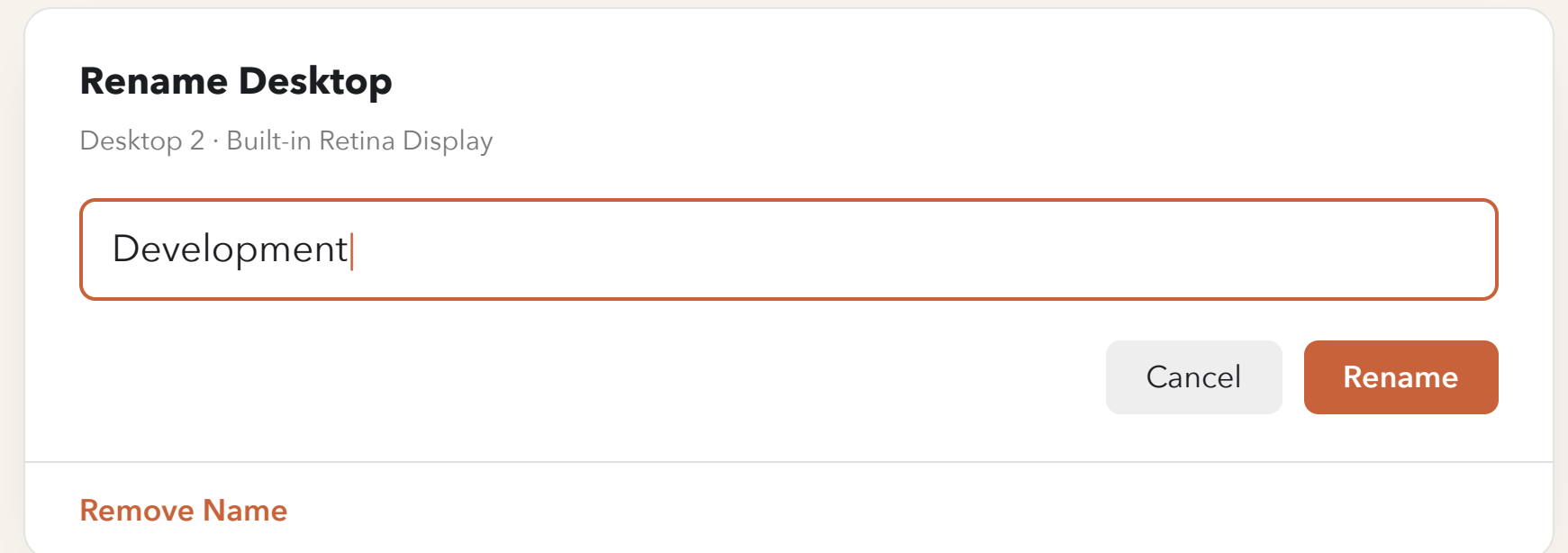
ACTION	KEY	NOTES
Open the desktop list		Global – works from any app. Configurable in Settings › Shortcuts.
Jump to a desktop	 ... 	While the list is open. Numbers follow the active display.
Move the focused window	 ... 	While the list is open; also the Move Window To... submenu.
Pin or unpin a window		Global toggle. Present only when Pin windows on top is enabled.
Rename this desktop		Renames the desktop you are on.
Open Settings		The standard macOS shortcut.

The two global hotkeys are yours to reassign. One word of warning from the project's own notes: the move-window default  collides with the system Minimize command, so change it to  in Settings › Shortcuts.

Type a name. It sticks to the space, *not the position*.

macOS identifies a space by a stable internal ID. Jumpee stores your name against that ID – so when you drag desktops around in Mission Control, the names travel with what is actually on them.

- **Return** renames, **Escape** cancels – a focused panel, not a stacked alert.
- **Remove Name** clears a desktop back to **Desktop 2**.
- Renaming applies to the desktop you are on right now.
- Names are written to the config file the moment you confirm.



Rename Desktop
Desktop 2 · Built-in Retina Display

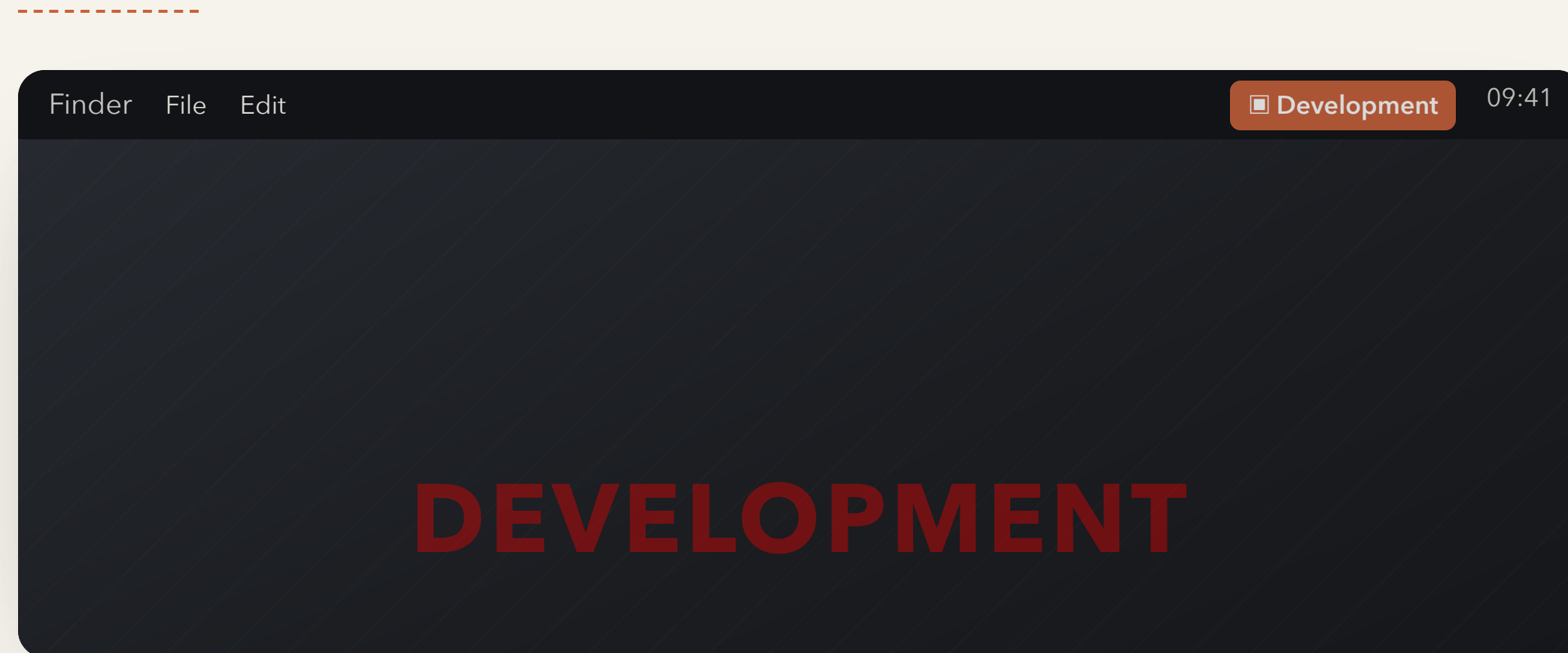
Development

Cancel Rename

Remove Name

The rename panel, as it appears over your current desktop.

The name, printed faintly *on the desktop itself*.



- 1 Seven anchors**
Any corner, top or bottom centre, or dead centre of the screen.
- 2 Opacity and colour**
Default is a 15% red. 10-20% reads as a watermark; 30-50% is meant to be noticed.
- 3 Font, size and weight**
Any installed font, from ultralight to black, plus a margin from the screen edge.
- 4 Click-through**
The overlay never takes a click and never appears in screenshots of your other windows.

Send the front window to another desktop – *without dragging*.

1

Focus the window you want to move

Click it once. Jumpee always acts on the frontmost window of the frontmost app.

2

Open Jumpee and pick Move Window To...

From the dropdown, from the submenu, or with `⌘1` – `⌘9` while the list is open. A global hotkey can open the same list at your cursor.

3

Pick the destination

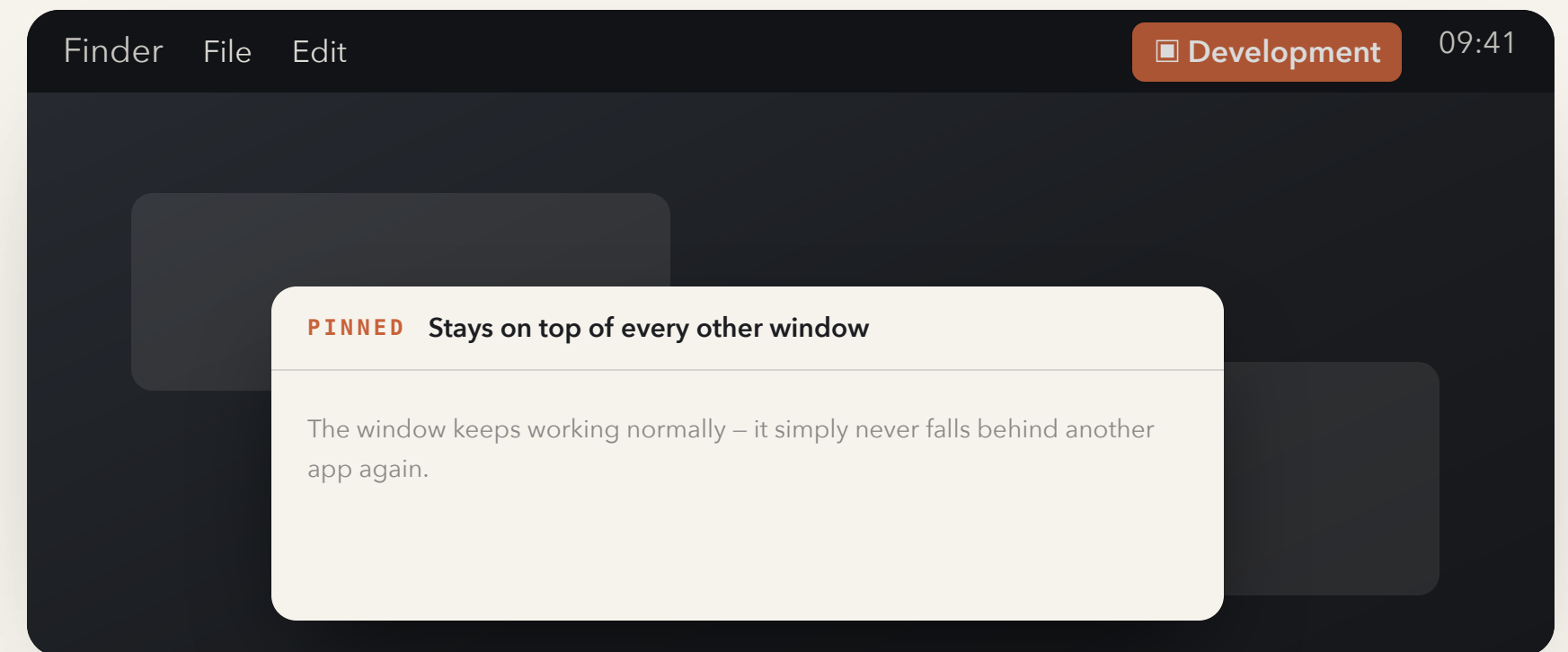
The window moves and your view follows it. The current desktop is left out of the list – you cannot move a window onto the desktop you are already on.

Two things to know. The system's *Move window to Desktop N* shortcuts must be enabled first – Jumpee reports their status in Settings › Advanced. And on macOS 15 and later the move always brings you along: "move without following" is a platform limitation, not a setting. Windows that cannot move – fullscreen, or assigned to all desktops – are simply left alone.

Keep one window *above all the others*.

Focus a window, press the pin shortcut, and it stays floating above everything else – including windows belonging to other apps.

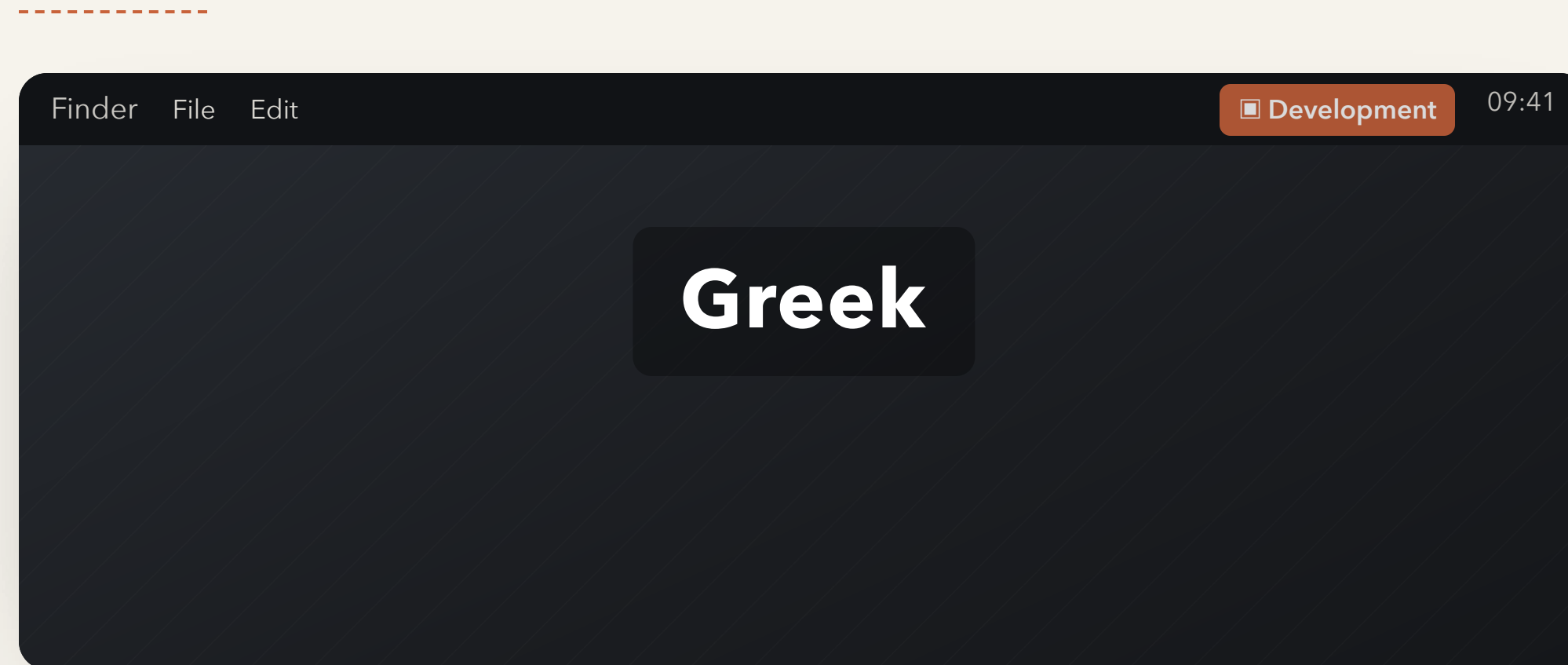
- Press `⌘P` again on the same window to unpin it.
- Several windows, from different apps, can be pinned at once.
- The menu item changes with the focused window: *Pin Window on Top* or *Unpin Window*.
- Pin state lives in memory only – quitting Jumpee releases every window it was holding.



Two unpinned windows behind, one pinned window holding the front.

Pinning is the one feature that needs **Screen Recording** permission, because the app works from a captured image of the window. Jumpee asks the first time you pin, and takes you to the right pane.

See the keyboard language *without hunting for it*.



- 1 Just below the menu bar**
Centred, notch-aware, on whichever display holds the space you are on.
- 2 Changes the instant you switch**
No polling – it listens for the system's input-source notification. Duplicate notices are ignored.
- 3 No new permissions**
The keyboard input-source APIs need nothing beyond what Jumpee already holds.
- 4 Independent of the watermark**
Text size, font, weight, colour, opacity, the background pill – and it runs happily alongside the desktop name.

02

More than one display

What changes when there is a second screen, and why the numbering stays local to each display.



Each display keeps *its own set of desktops*.

The list	Shows only the spaces belonging to the display you are working on – not a flattened list of everything.
The numbers	<code>⌘1</code> – <code>⌘9</code> follow that display's own numbering, starting at 1 on each screen.
The watermark	Appears on the display holding the active space, and repositions when you move to the other one.
The indicator	Same rule – the keyboard language follows the active display, with the menu bar height measured per screen so notched and external displays both sit correctly.
Plugging in	Connecting or disconnecting a display rebuilds the menu and the overlays for the new layout. Nothing restarts.

Window moves respect the same topology: a window is sent to a desktop on the active display, using the global numbering the system shortcuts expect.

03

Installing it

One Homebrew line or a disk image – then two settings macOS will not let Jumpee change on its own.



One line, if you use Homebrew.

```
# add the tap, then install the cask
brew tap BikS2013/jumpee
brew install --cask jumpee

# launch it
open -a Jumpee

# and when you want it gone
brew uninstall --cask jumpee
```

1 Or download a release

A `.dmg` to drag onto Applications, or a `.zip` to unpack. Both are on the project's releases page.

2 Signed and notarized

From v1.6.0 every release is Developer ID signed, checked by Apple and stapled – so Gatekeeper opens it without a warning. Only v1.5.1 and older need the quarantine flag cleared.

3 macOS 13 or later

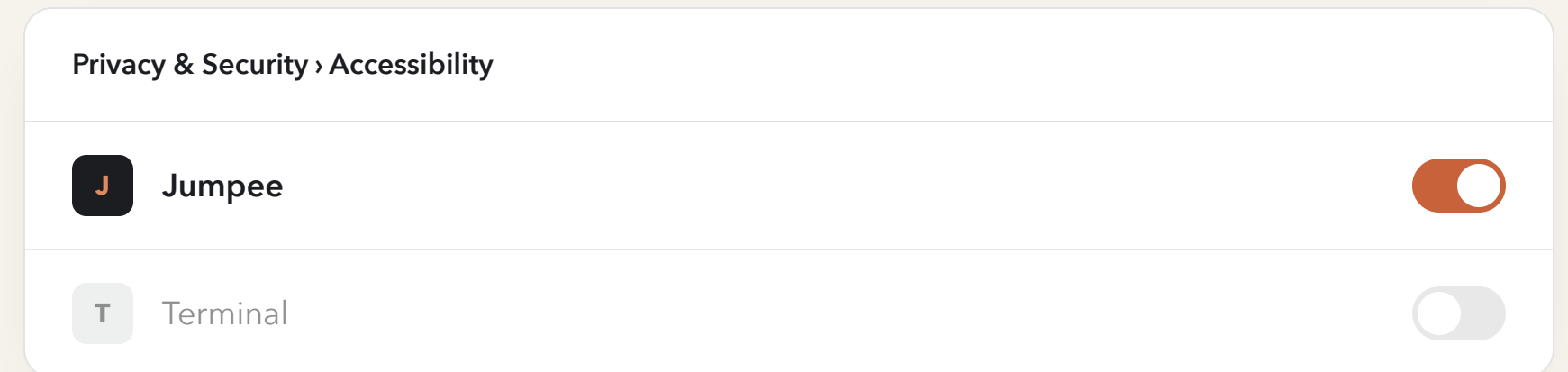
Ventura, Sonoma, Sequoia and Tahoe. One universal download covers Apple silicon and Intel.

4 No dependencies

A single native Swift binary. Building it yourself needs only the Xcode Command Line Tools – no full Xcode.

Grant Accessibility. *Nothing switches without it.*

Jumpee never reaches into another app. To change desktop, it asks macOS to run the system's own shortcut – and synthesising that keystroke sits behind Accessibility, which macOS will not let an app grant to itself.



Switching desktops and moving windows both need this one permission.

1

Open the pane

System Settings › Privacy & Security › Accessibility.

2

Switch Jumpee on

If it is not listed, click `+` and add `/Applications/Jumpee.app`.

3

Or follow the prompt

Jumpee asks on first launch and takes you straight there.

Turn on *Switch to Desktop 1-9*.

There is no public API for changing desktop. Jumpee presses macOS's own `^1` ... `^9` shortcuts – and those ship switched off.

- 1

Open the shortcut list

System Settings › Keyboard › Keyboard Shortcuts › Mission Control.
- 2

Tick the desktop shortcuts

Switch to Desktop 1 through Switch to Desktop 9.
- 3

Leave them alone afterwards

Changing them to another key breaks navigation – Jumpee expects the system defaults.

Keyboard Shortcuts › Mission Control		
Switch to Desktop 1	<code>^1</code>	✓
Switch to Desktop 2	<code>^2</code>	✓
Switch to Desktop 3	<code>^3</code>	✓
Switch to Desktop 4	<code>^4</code>	–

Skip these and the list still draws correctly – but clicking a desktop goes nowhere.

Screen Recording is only for pinning.

REQUIRED – FOR PINNING ONLY

Screen Recording

Pinning works from a captured image of the window, so macOS gates it behind Screen Recording. Leave it off and everything else still works; the first time you pin, Jumpee asks and opens the pane for you.

System Settings › Privacy & Security › Screen Recording

OPTIONAL

Launch at login

Jumpee does not install itself as a login item. If you want it waiting at every start, add it yourself – it is one toggle in System Settings › General › Login Items.

Until then, start it from Spotlight whenever you want it.

The whole setup in one line: **one permission** for naming, switching and the overlays, **a second** only for pinning, and **one set of system shortcuts** that macOS keeps switched off by default.

04

Settings and configuration

Four panes in a real macOS Settings window, one JSON file underneath, and no Apply button anywhere.



A real macOS Settings window – *four panes*.

PANE 01

General

Which features exist at all: the menu bar icon, the desktop number, overlay, indicator, window moving and pinning.

PANE 02

Appearance

How the two overlays look – type, colour, opacity, anchor – with a live preview beside the controls.

PANE 03

Shortcuts

Three global hotkeys, recorded by pressing them, with conflict checking and a reset on every row.

PANE 04

Advanced

Permission status, the config file in Finder, and Reload Now for edits made by hand.

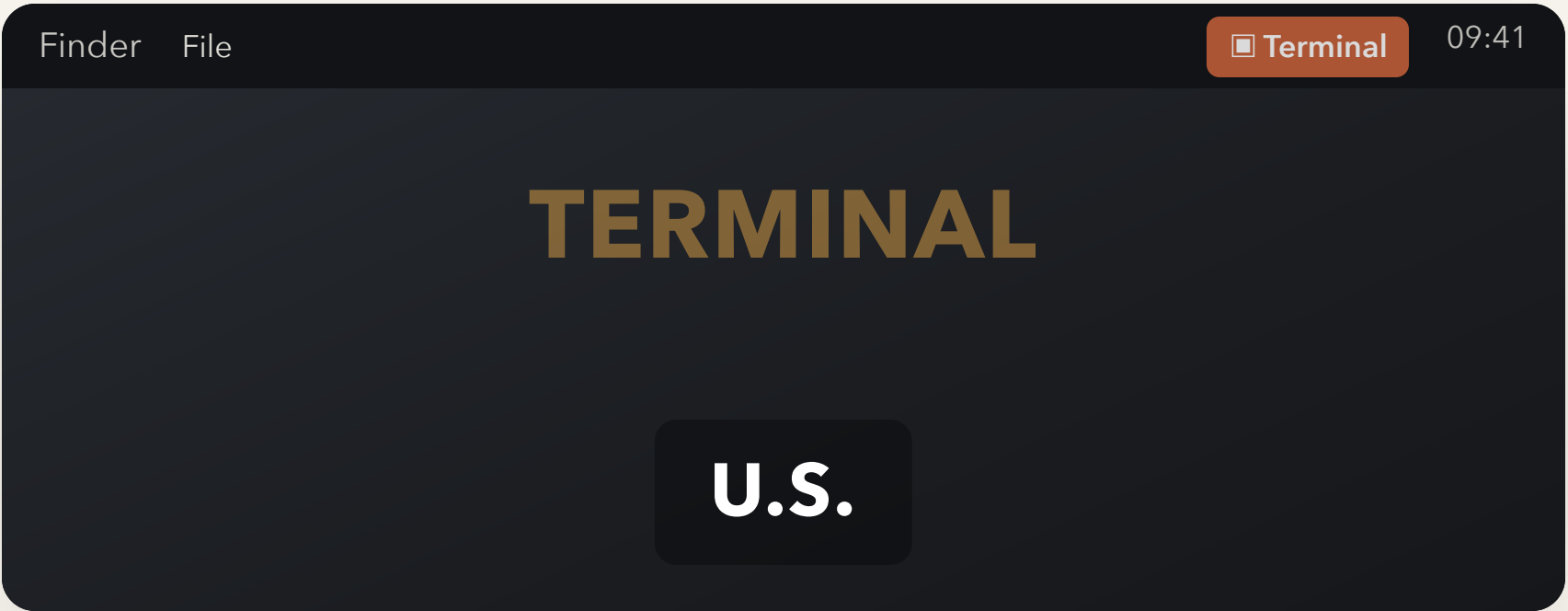
No Apply button. Every control writes straight through to the configuration and takes effect immediately. The window resizes and retitles itself to match the pane you pick, and `⌘,` opens it from anywhere.

General decides what exists.

Menu bar icon	Hide the status item and keep the hotkeys. With the icon hidden, the list opens at the cursor instead.
Desktop number	4: Browser or just Browser – your choice, everywhere the name appears.
Dropdown at cursor	Open the list where the pointer happens to be, or at the menu bar item. Cursor is the default.
Desktop overlay	The wallpaper watermark, on or off.
Input source indicator	The keyboard-language overlay, on or off.
Move windows / Pin windows on top	Each feature brings its own menu entries and its own hotkey – and takes them away again when switched off.

Appearance, *with a live preview*.

Watermark	Font, size, weight, text colour, opacity, anchor and margin from the edge.
Indicator text	Size, font, weight, colour, opacity and a vertical offset below the menu bar.
Indicator pill	Background colour, background opacity and corner radius.
Restore defaults	Resets the visuals but keeps each feature's on/off state – and keeps your per-language labels.



Both overlays in one preview – the watermark and the input-source pill, styled independently.

Record a shortcut *by pressing it*.

No checkbox-and-text-field fiddling. Click the control, press the chord you want, and it is captured whole – modifiers and all, including named keys like Space, Return, Tab and Escape.

- **Escape** with no modifiers cancels recording.
- A shortcut needs at least one modifier, a key from the supported set, and no clash with the other two.
- Applying it re-registers the hotkey immediately – no restart, no manual reload.
- Every row has its own reset, and there is one *Restore Defaults* for all three.
- Rows for disabled features stay visible, greyed out, so you can see what is available.

Shortcuts		
Open Jumpee	 J	Reset
Move Current Window	Recording...	Reset
Pin or Unpin Window	  P	Reset

The third row is greyed out because Pin windows on top is switched off in General.

Advanced tells you what macOS is holding back.

STATUS

Three checks, one screen

- **Accessibility** – granted or not, with a way through to the pane.
- **Mission Control shortcuts** – whether Switch to Desktop 1-9 are detected, plus a *Review Shortcuts...* button.
- **Screen Recording** – the permission pinning depends on.

No guessing why a feature is quiet.

THE FILE

Reveal and reload

- **Reveal config file** opens the JSON in Finder.
- **Reload Now** re-reads it and re-registers every hotkey – no restart.
- Everything the Settings panes do lands in that same file, so hand-edits and UI edits never diverge.

Edited by hand and it did not take? Reload Now is the answer.

Everything the app knows, in *one file*.

```
{
  "hotkey":      { "key": "j", "modifiers": ["command"] },
  "moveWindow": { "enabled": true },
  "pinWindow":   { "enabled": true },
  "overlay": {
    "enabled": true, "fontSize": 72, "fontWeight": "bold",
    "opacity": 0.15, "position": "top-center",
    "textColor": "#FF0000", "margin": 40
  },
  "showSpaceNumber": true,
  "spaces": { "42": "Mail & Calendar", "15": "Development" }
}
```

1 ~/.tool-agents/jumpee/config.json

The folder is created `0700` and the file `0600`. It is written for you on first run and it is the only configuration method – no environment variables, no command-line flags.

2 Spaces are keyed by ID, not position

`"42"` is the space's stable internal ID. That is why names survive a reshuffle – and why you should rename from the menu rather than editing keys by hand.

3 Coming from an older build?

Legacy configs are migrated automatically – position-keyed spaces to ID-keyed, and the old `~/Jumpee/` folder to the new path on first launch.

05

Where it fits

Three working habits it suits, and an honest list of what it still will not do.



Three places it *earns its keep*.

01

One machine, four jobs

Comms, development, terminal, browser – four desktops, four names, no memorising. `⌘J` then the number, from inside any app, without losing your place.

The menu bar answers "where am I?" before you have to ask.

02

Presenting and screen sharing

Your audience sees the space name printed on the desktop you are sharing, and the input-source pill stops the mid-sentence "why is my typing in Greek?" moment before it happens.

Both overlays are click-through, so nothing you demo is blocked.

03

A reference that must not vanish

Pin the document, dashboard or call transcript you are working from above everything else, then edit underneath it. Unpin when you are done – or quit, and Jumpee releases it for you.

Several pinned windows at once, from different apps.

It suits anyone who already thinks in desktops but cannot remember what is on each one – and anyone whose work mixes two keyboard languages across two screens.

What it does *not* do.

LIMIT	WHY
Nine desktops per display	Switching rides on the system's <code>^1</code> – <code>^9</code> shortcuts, so there is nothing beyond the ninth.
Moving a window always follows it	macOS 15 and later force the view across with the window. Not a setting, a platform rule.
Space detection rests on private APIs	macOS offers no public way to read the current space, so Jumpee uses undocumented CoreGraphics calls. A future release could break them.
The watermark shows the current space only	Printing each name into the Mission Control thumbnails is not reachable on current macOS.
Pins are forgotten at quit	Pin state is kept in memory by design, so nothing is left floating after Jumpee exits.
The <code>⌘M</code> default clashes with Minimize	Change it to <code>⇧⌘M</code> – a known trade-off recorded in the project's own notes.

Three steps and you are *done*.

30

1

Install it

`brew install --cask jumpee` after tapping the repository, or take the disk image from the releases page.

2

Grant Accessibility and switch on Desktop 1-9

One permission and one set of system shortcuts. Settings › Advanced confirms both.

3

Name your first desktop

Press `⌘N`, type the name, press Return. The menu bar answers to it from that moment on.